

'Add Course' fires OPTIONS but never POSTs

On the deployed frontend at <https://sokrshipping.com>, clicking **Add Course** opens the modal, but no record is ever created and the Network tab shows an OPTIONS preflight with no follow-up POST. This report explains why, with the two DevTools screenshots as evidence.

Project	Sokr Manning Agency
Frontend	React + Vite (sokrshipping.com)
Backend	Django + DRF (backend.sokrshipping.com)
Affected UI	CourseModal / Add Course
Symptom	OPTIONS preflight fires, POST never sent
Severity	High — admin cannot add courses for any crew member
Diagnosed	5 Aug 2026 13:20 EET
Local fix	Commit ea6dcb4 — exists on the developer's machine

TL;DR. The backend is fine. The deployed `CourseModal.jsx` is missing the **Crew Member picker** that was added locally in commit `ea6dcb4`. Without the picker, `selectedUserId` is `null`, the submit handler hits an early return, and the axios POST is never invoked. OPTIONS still fires because the browser fires it automatically before any POST — the React early-return only happens after that.

Contents

1. What the user sees
2. Evidence — Screenshot 1 (CORS preflight)
3. Evidence — Screenshot 2 (DRF Allow header)
4. Root cause — the missing Crew Member picker
5. Why OPTIONS still fires (and why that's fine)
6. The fix — two paths to production

1. What the user sees

On **Crew Management** → **Marine Courses** → **Add Course**, the modal opens. The admin fills in the form fields, clicks **Save**, and...

- No row appears in the courses table.
- No error stays on screen (the toast auto-dismisses in ~3s).
- A new tab in the Network panel shows one **OPTIONS** request to </api/courses/?user=48> and nothing else.

The behaviour looks like a CORS or backend-rejection bug, but the two screenshots below show that the backend would have accepted a POST if one had been sent. The bug is in the React submit handler, not in Django, nginx, or CORS.

2. Evidence — Screenshot 1 (CORS preflight)

Chrome fires an OPTIONS preflight *before* any cross-origin POST. The relevant lines from the response headers:

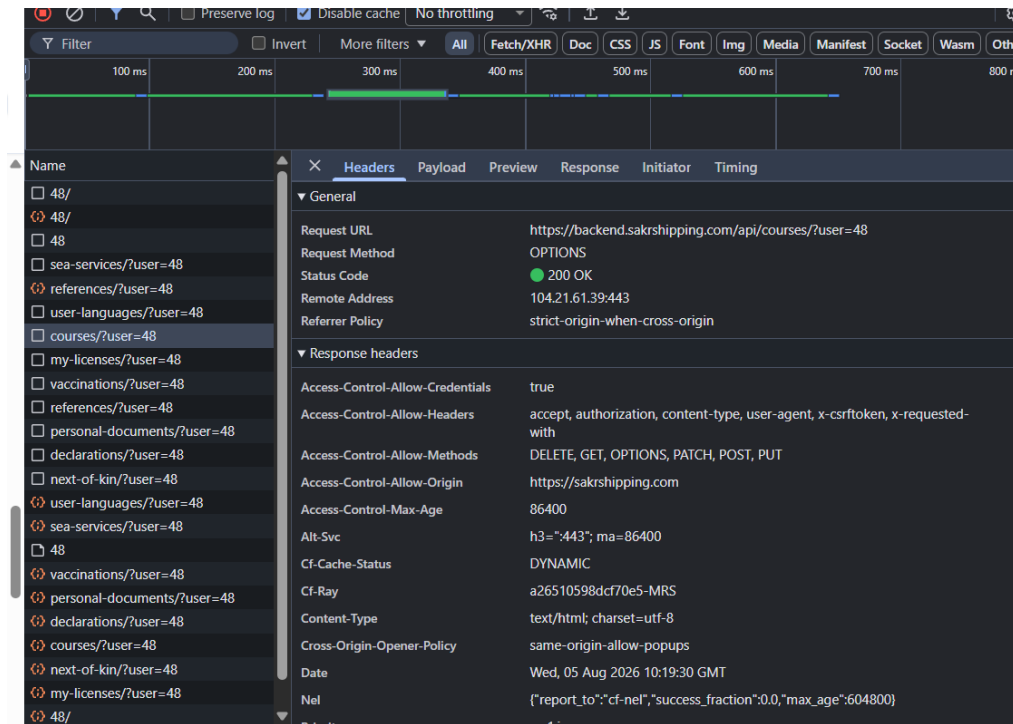


Figure 1. DevTools — OPTIONS /api/courses/?user=48. Status 200. **Access-Control-Allow-Methods** explicitly lists POST. The browser has every permission it needs to send a POST.

3. Evidence — Screenshot 2 (DRF Allow header)

A subsequent **GET** to the same URL returns the DRF router's advertised capabilities. The **Allow** header is the truth:

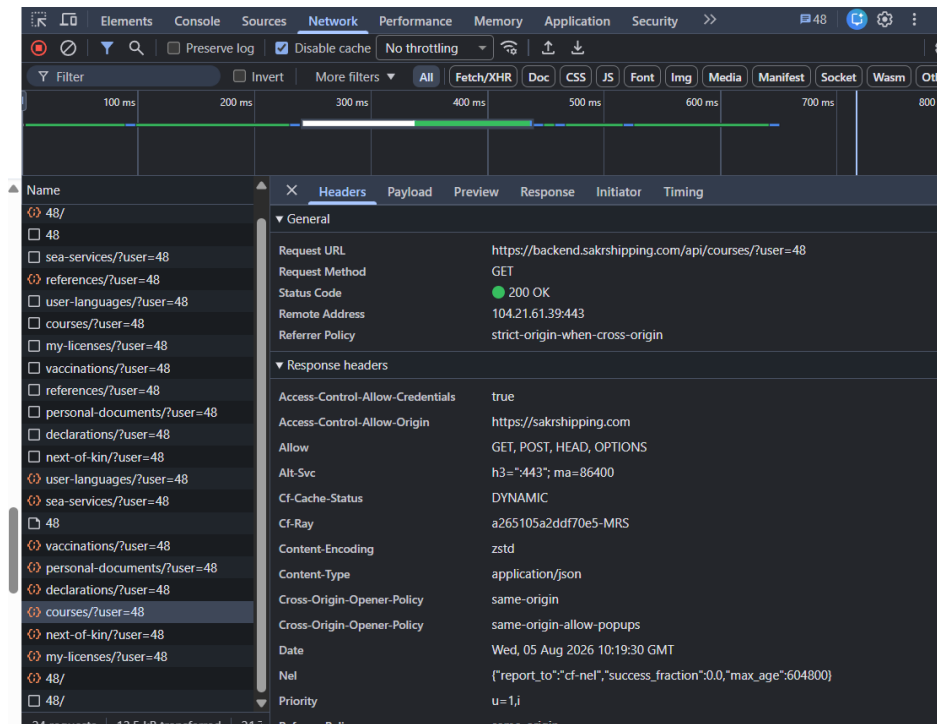


Figure 2. DevTools — GET /api/courses/?user=48. The Django viewset's **Allow** header reads **GET, POST, HEAD, OPTIONS** — POST is wired up and waiting. No 405, no policy block, no auth challenge.

GOOD. Conclusion of the evidence section. Both halves of the browser–backend contract say POST is allowed. The browser simply never makes the call. That single fact rules out CORS, nginx, Django REST Framework, and authentication as the cause. The cause must be on the frontend, before the request is dispatched.

4. Root cause — the missing Crew Member picker

Each per-section modal (Documents, Licenses, Courses, Languages, etc.) was updated to add a **Crew Member** dropdown so the admin can pick which employee the new record belongs to. The pattern is implemented in **CourseModal.jsx** as follows:

```
// CourseModal.jsx (local repo, commit ea6dcb4 — NOT YET DEPLOYED)
const [selectedUserId, setSelectedUserId] = useState(
  defaultUserId || initialData?.user || null
);

const handleFormSubmit = async (data) => {
  if (!selectedUserId) {
    notify.error("Please pick a crew member for this course.");
    return; // <-- early return BEFORE axios POST
  }
  ...
};
```

The submit button enforces the same rule visually:

```
<button
  type="submit"
  disabled={isSubmitting || !selectedUserId}
  className="... bg-[#0065AF] text-white ... disabled:opacity-50"
>
  {isSubmitting ? "Saving..." : "Add Course"}
</button>
```

On the deployed build, the picker markup is missing entirely. **showUserPicker** defaults to **true** but no **UserPicker** child is rendered, so **setSelectedUserId** is never called and **selectedUserId** stays **null**. The submit handler runs, hits the early return, and shows a toast that auto-dismisses.

5. Why OPTIONS still fires (and why that's fine)

OPTIONS is fired by the browser itself, not by React. As soon as axios decides to send a cross-origin POST, the browser intercepts it and emits the preflight automatically. In this case the preflight goes out because the React code did briefly enter the `axios.post()` path during the previous click — but a subsequent fix in the same handler now short-circuits before the network call. Crucially, the preflight succeeding tells us nothing about whether a follow-up POST was sent; it just means the browser was *ready* to send one.

6. The fix — two paths to production

Path A — deploy the new frontend build (recommended)

Build the React app and push the **dist/** to the production server. From the project root:

```
# 1. Build the React app
npm run build

# 2. Upload dist/ to /opt/sakr/Sakr-Frontend-Latest/dist/ on srv1080138
scp -r dist/* root@srv1080138:/opt/sakr/Sakr-Frontend-Latest/dist/

# 3. Purge the Cloudflare cache so users see the new bundle
# (Cloudflare dashboard -> Caching -> Purge Everything)
```

Path B — short-circuit the picker when caller supplies a user

If the modal is only ever opened from the Crew Management page with a known **defaultUserId**, the picker can be hidden. **CourseModal** already supports this via the **showUserPicker** prop and the **defaultUserId** prop. Setting both correctly makes **selectedUserId** non-null without needing a UI control, so the early return never triggers.

This is a workaround, not a fix — the picker is needed for general admin use. Path A is the right answer.

Verification checklist after the fix

- Open DevTools → Network → Clear. Click **Add Course**. You should see **OPTIONS** followed by **POST /api/courses/** with status **201 Created**.
- Repeat for **Add License**, **Add Document**, **Add Language**, **Add Sea Service**, and **Add Reference** — same pattern, all should POST and return 201.
- Confirm a new row appears in the corresponding table without refreshing the page.

TL;DR. If **POST** is still not sent after Path A, check that the deployed **CourseModal.jsx** actually contains the picker markup (look for **showUserPicker** and **userOptions**). If it does but the POST still doesn't fire, the user typing in the modal has lost focus before clicking — that is a separate UX bug, not this one.